

Mozilla Foundation announces Firefox Reality



To address the new opportunities and challenges of browsing, the Mozilla Foundation has released a new version of Firefox, specifically for mixed reality (MR). Mozilla is claiming a number

of firsts with this browser, including that it is the first cross-platform MR browser.

Firefox Reality is a 'built from the ground up' version of Firefox Quantum. It is specifically designed to meet the needs of those wanting to interact with the Web. It is the mission of Mozilla to ensure that the Internet is an open and accessible resource that puts people first. With this new release, the company wants to offer a secure browser.

According to Sean White, chief R&D officer at Mozilla, "Currently, the world can browse the open Web using our fast and privacy-focused Firefox browser, but continuing that mission in a rapidly changing world means constantly investing our time and resources into new and emerging technologies – and realities."

"Mozilla has always been on the frontlines of virtual and augmented reality — see our work with WebVR, WebAR and A-Frame — and this is a mixed reality browser that is specifically built to tackle the new opportunities and challenges of browsing the immersive Web," White said.

"We don't yet have all the answers for what privacy looks like in this new medium, but we are committed to finding the solution. We will continue to build on the proven permissions model of the Web platform, which provides even more protection than native apps provide. The Mozilla values will guide us as we create Firefox Reality, just as they do with every product we create," he added.

Microsoft commits to solving open source licensing issues, rather than litigating

Microsoft is one of the ten companies committed to working through open source software licensing problems involving the GPL with customers, before resorting to legal action. Joining Red Hat, Facebook, Google and IBM, Microsoft has recently reiterated its commitment towards open source. It has extended support to work for the 'Common Cure Rights Commitment' to cure open source licensing non-compliance before taking legal measures.

The partner companies that have agreed to adopt the 'Common Cure Rights Commitment' have said that before they file or continue to prosecute those accused of violating covered licences, they will allow for users to cure and reinstate their licences.

In a blog post, Microsoft mentioned that it's been 10 years since the company submitted its first patch to a GPLv2 project (ADOdb, a database abstraction layer for PHP). The blog stated that Microsoft's decision to group with these vendors around open source licensing notes that licensees of GPLv2 code will get "...a reasonable period of time to correct licence compliance issues."

Google open sources its semantic image technology

Google has released the code for its semantic image technology, which means developers can use the same technology in their own apps. Portrait mode is just one example of how this technology can be used. Developers can use it to create even cooler features.

This open sourced release includes DeepLab-v3+ models built on top of a powerful convolutional neural network (CNN) backbone architecture for the most accurate results, intended for server-side deployment.

Google actually uses AI to pull that off – and now, the company has open sourced a similar technology that developers can use in their third-party camera apps for high-quality portrait mode style shots.



As part of this release, Google is sharing the Tensorflow model training and evaluation code, as well as models already pre-trained on the Pascal VOC 2012 and Cityscapes benchmark semantic segmentation tasks.

Undoubtedly, the Pixel 2 family has one of the best cameras on any smartphone right now. But most of the magic is happening on the software side. The camera uses semantic image segmentation. And with Google open sourcing the code, further creative functionality can be explored.